Boom-Bap Drum Bus

Sounds like: 90s East Coast knock — DJ Premier / Pete Rock era

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`All drums -> bus channel -> Scream 4 -> MClass Compressor -> channel EQ`

Starting material: programmed drums (Redrum/Kong) or chopped breaks

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DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. Route every drum (kick, snare, hats, perc) to one bus channel. This recipe lives on the BUS, elements stay mostly raw.

2. Scream 4 on the bus: Damage type Digital, Damage 30–45, P1 (rate) down around 60–70 to fake bit-reduction grit. This is the SP-1200 impression.

3. MClass Compressor: ratio 6:1, attack medium-fast (~10 ms), release fast, 4–6 dB reduction. Yes, that's heavy — boom-bap bus compression is an effect, not glue.

4. Channel EQ on the bus: +2 dB at 80 Hz (boom), -2 dB at 500 Hz (cardboard), +1.5 dB at 7 kHz (dust and air).

5. If it pumps musically, you're done. If it pumps annoyingly, slow the release slightly.

6. Optional: nudge snare timing a few ticks LATE by hand. The lazy snare is half the boom-bap feel — no plugin does this, it's sequencing.

Why this works

Heavy bus compression makes hits mash into each other (the "knock"); digital-type saturation supplies vintage-sampler grime.

Why this order

Scream before comp: the compressor should slam the already-dirty signal — reversing it makes the dirt level jump around.

Reason trick

Do the chopping in Kong's NN-Nano or NN-XT, one hit per pad, then this bus chain unifies hits from different records into one kit.

The skill you just learned

Processing the group instead of the parts — cohesion comes from shared abuse.

Worth buying?
For the true 12-bit artifact: a bit-crusher RE or free VST (decimort-style). Marginal gain — the compressor is 80% of this sound.